Northwind Coffee Co.
Customer Help Center

Edition 2026. A fictional sample document.

1. Welcome to our help center

About this guide

This guide answers the questions customers ask us most about ordering, shipping, returns, subscriptions, our coffees, brewing, gift cards, wholesale and our cafés. Northwind Coffee Co. is a fictional business made up for a software demo, and every name, address and price in this guide is invented.

Who we are

Northwind Coffee Co. is a small-batch roaster in Halifax, Nova Scotia, founded in 2014 by Maya Okafor and Liam Doucette. We roast on a 15 kg cast-iron drum roaster we call Old Tom, and we run three cafés.

Getting help from a person

Our support team is available Monday to Friday, 9 am to 5 pm Atlantic time. Email hello@northwind.example or call (902) 555-0142, and we reply within one business day. Please include your order number if your question is about an order.

2. Ordering and shipping

Where we ship

We ship to Canada and the United States, including every US state. We don't ship outside Canada and the United States yet, so we can't send orders to the UK, Europe, Australia or Mexico. All prices are in Canadian dollars (CAD).

When your order ships

We roast Monday to Thursday. Orders placed before 12 pm Atlantic time on a roast day are roasted and shipped the next business day. A tracking link is emailed as soon as your order ships.

Shipping times and costs

Standard shipping in Canada costs $8 and takes 2 to 5 business days. Express shipping in Canada costs $16 and takes 1 to 2 business days. Standard shipping to the United States (US) costs $14 and takes 4 to 8 business days.

Free shipping

Shipping is free on orders over $45 in Canada and over $75 to the United States. Local pickup from our Harbour Street café is always free, and orders are ready the next business day.

Changing an order

You can change the address or items on an order within 2 hours of placing it. Email hello@northwind.example with your order number. After that, the order may already be roasting.

3. Returns and refunds

Our taste guarantee

If a coffee isn't for you, tell us within 30 days of delivery and we'll send a different coffee or refund it, even if the bag is open. This works once per order.

Returning brewing gear

Brewing gear can be returned unused, in its original box, within 30 days of delivery. We email a prepaid return label for gear returns in Canada. US customers pay return shipping.

Damaged or wrong items

If something arrives damaged or wrong, email a photo within 7 days and we'll replace it at no cost.

How refunds work

Refunds go back to the original payment method within 5 to 7 business days of approval. Gift cards and opened brewing gear are final sale. To start a return, email hello@northwind.example with your order number.

4. Subscriptions

How subscriptions work

A subscription delivers fresh coffee every 1, 2, 3 or 4 weeks, and you choose the coffee, the grind and the frequency. Subscribers save 10 percent on every bag. Subscriptions ship free anywhere in Canada. US subscriptions ship free over $75.

Pause or skip a delivery

You can pause your subscription for up to 3 months at a time, and it restarts automatically on the date you pick. Skip any single delivery from your account, up to the change deadline. Changes must be made at least 2 days before your next ship date.

Change or cancel

You can change your coffee, grind, frequency or address at any time. Cancel any time from your account. There are no fees and no minimum number of deliveries. Changes and cancellations made at least 2 days before your next ship date apply to that delivery.

Roaster's Choice

Roaster's Choice sends a different single origin each delivery, picked by our roasting team.

Managing your subscription

Manage everything at northwind.example/account, or reply to any shipping email and we'll do it for you.

5. Our coffees

Roast levels

We roast light, medium and medium-dark. Light roasts taste brighter and more fruity, medium roasts are balanced and sweet, and medium-dark roasts are rich and low in acidity.

Harbour Blend

Harbour Blend is a medium roast from Brazil and Colombia (Cerrado and Huila), natural and washed. Harbour Blend tastes of milk chocolate, toasted almond and brown sugar. Harbour Blend is best for drip, French press and cold brew. A 340 g bag of Harbour Blend costs $19.

First Light

First Light is a light roast from Ethiopia (Yirgacheffe), washed. First Light tastes of bergamot, peach and jasmine. First Light is best for pour-over and filter. A 340 g bag of First Light costs $22.

Night Shift Espresso

Night Shift Espresso is a medium-dark roast from Brazil and Guatemala (Mogiana and Huehuetenango), natural and washed. Night Shift Espresso tastes of cocoa, molasses and dark cherry. Night Shift Espresso is best for espresso, moka pot and milk drinks. A 340 g bag of Night Shift Espresso costs $20.

Huila Valley

Huila Valley is a medium roast from Colombia (Huila), washed. Huila Valley tastes of red apple, caramel and orange zest. Huila Valley is best for pour-over, drip and AeroPress. A 340 g bag of Huila Valley costs $21.

Kirinyaga Peaberry

Kirinyaga Peaberry is a light roast from Kenya (Kirinyaga), washed. Kirinyaga Peaberry tastes of blackcurrant, grapefruit and cane sugar. Kirinyaga Peaberry is best for pour-over and filter. A 340 g bag of Kirinyaga Peaberry costs $24.

Still Water Decaf

Still Water Decaf is a medium roast from Colombia (Tolima), sugarcane decaf. Still Water Decaf tastes of chocolate, plum and honey. Still Water Decaf is best for any brew method. A 340 g bag of Still Water Decaf costs $20.

How decaf is made

Still Water Decaf is decaffeinated in Colombia with the sugarcane process, which uses ethyl acetate made from fermented sugarcane and water. It removes about 97 percent of the caffeine.

Freshness and grind options

Every bag is roasted to order and shows its roast date. Coffee tastes best from 5 to 30 days after roasting. Every coffee is available as whole bean, or ground for espresso, pour-over, drip or French press.

Allergens

Our roastery handles only coffee beans. We don't roast flavoured coffees, and no nuts, dairy, gluten or soy are used in the roastery. Pastries in our cafés may contain nuts, milk, eggs or wheat.

Sourcing

We buy green coffee from importers who pay producers above the Fairtrade minimum, and we publish the price we pay for each coffee.

6. Brewing guides

Pour-over

For pour-over, use 22 g of coffee for 350 g of water, a 1:16 ratio. Grind medium-fine, use water at 93 to 96 °C, and brew for 3 to 3.5 minutes. Bloom with twice the coffee's weight in water for 30 seconds first.

French press

For French press, use 30 g of coffee for 450 g of water, a 1:15 ratio. Grind coarse, use water at 94 °C, and brew for 4 minutes. Stir after one minute, press slowly at four minutes, and pour right away.

Espresso

For espresso, use 18 g of coffee for 36 g of espresso, a 1:2 ratio. Grind fine, use water at 92 to 94 °C, and brew for 27 to 32 seconds. If a shot runs fast and tastes sour, grind finer. If it runs slow and tastes bitter, grind coarser.

Storing coffee

Keep beans in their resealable bag or an airtight container, away from light and heat. Don't keep coffee in the fridge. Grind just before brewing for the best flavour.

7. Gift cards and wholesale

Gift cards

Gift cards come in $25, $50 and $100 amounts. Digital gift cards are emailed right away, or on a date you choose. Gift cards never expire. Gift cards work on one-time orders, subscriptions and in our cafés. Gift cards can't be exchanged for cash.

Wholesale for businesses

We supply coffee shops, restaurants and offices. The minimum order is 5 kg per order. Free delivery in the Halifax area every Tuesday and Friday. Elsewhere we ship by courier. New coffee shop partners get two free barista training sessions and help dialling in their grinder.

Becoming a wholesale partner

Email wholesale@northwind.example with your business name and expected weekly volume. We reply within 2 business days.

8. Cafés, hours and contact

Harbour Street café

Our Harbour Street café is at 112 Harbour Street, Halifax. Opening hours at Harbour Street are 7 am to 6 pm Monday to Friday, 8 am to 5 pm on Saturday, and 8 am to 5 pm on Sunday. Our first café, and the pickup point for online orders.

Roastery café

Our Roastery café is at 40 Foundry Lane, Dartmouth. Opening hours at Roastery are 8 am to 4 pm Monday to Friday, 9 am to 3 pm on Saturday, and closed on Sunday. Free roastery tours run on Saturdays at 10 am.

Willow Row café

Our Willow Row café is at 18 Willow Row, Halifax. Opening hours at Willow Row are 7:30 am to 5 pm Monday to Friday, 8 am to 4 pm on Saturday, and 8 am to 4 pm on Sunday. A quiet back room for reading and studying.

Holidays and amenities

All cafés close on December 25 and January 1. Holiday hours are posted on our website a week ahead. Free Wi-Fi in every café. Dogs are welcome on the Harbour Street patio.

Contact us

Email hello@northwind.example or call (902) 555-0142, Monday to Friday, 9 am to 5 pm Atlantic time. For wholesale, email wholesale@northwind.example.